

Executive Summary

Raichu is a new browser-based abstract strategy game with chess-like appeal. This report defines an SEO strategy to make Raichu discoverable among fans of chess variants and abstract board games. It identifies **primary keyword clusters** (e.g. “chess-like games”, “abstract strategy board games”, “how to play [game]”), and compiles a **long-tail keyword list** focused on discovery and how-to searches. We analyze top sites (Chess.com, Lichess, PlayStrategy, PlayAbstractGames, AbstractBoardGames.com, ChessFort, 247Chess) for title-tag patterns, content structure, keyword targets, internal linking, and schema use.

The report proposes a **site map** (core pages like Home, Play, Rules, How-to, Strategy, Chess-like Games, Abstract Strategy Games, Chess Variants, Raichu vs Chess, FAQ, Blog) with suggested **title/meta/H1** for each page. We detail a **schema plan** (JSON-LD for VideoGame/Game on gameplay pages, HowTo on tutorials, FAQPage on FAQ, BreadcrumbList on info pages, Article on blog posts). An **internal linking plan** ensures connectivity between core pages and blog. A **content roadmap** lists 20 blog article ideas with outlines, aimed at long-tail discovery (e.g. “Best games like chess,” “Raichu vs Chess,” “Chess variants explained,” etc.). A **technical SEO checklist** covers titles, meta tags, crawlability, mobile-friendliness, and structured data ¹ ² . Finally, a **30-day launch plan** is outlined (with weekly milestones and KPIs) using a Gantt-chart, followed by a prioritized list of implementation tasks.

This structured approach – emphasizing clear titles, unique descriptions, targeted long-tail content, and rich schema – will help Raichu rank for chess-adjacent queries and gain initial traction.

Keyword Strategy

Primary Keyword Clusters:

Cluster	Sample Keywords / Intent	Comments
Chess-like Games	games like chess, chess variant, chess-inspired game, unique chess games, new chess board game	Discovery queries for alternatives or variants (high discovery value)
Abstract Strategy	abstract strategy games online, free abstract board games, no luck board game, two-player strategy game	Audience looking for strategy games beyond chess (discovery)
Browser Playable	play abstract game online, browser board games, free browser strategy game, online strategy board games	Transactional intent: play for free, quick play in browser
How-to / Tutorials	how to play [Raichu], [Raichu] game rules, [Raichu] beginner guide, [Raichu] strategy tips	Informational intent: people learning new game (Raichu)
Comparisons	Raichu vs Chess, chess vs [Raichu], best games like chess and checkers	Queries comparing similar games (informational)
Category / Lists	best strategy games 2026, best chess variants, top abstract board games	Discovery searches for game recommendations

Long-Tail Keywords (by intent):

- *Discovery*: “best games like chess” “unique chess variant browser game” “two-player abstract strategy games list” “free abstract board games online” “no-luck strategy board game”

- *How-to/Informational*: “how to play Raichu game” “Raichu game rules explained” “Raichu beginner strategy guide” “winning tactics in [Raichu]” “difference between chess and [Raichu]”
- *Transactional/Play*: “play [Raichu] online free” “browser chess-like game Raichu” “open-source abstract strategy games online”

We'll target mid-volume phrases around “*games like chess*”, “*abstract strategy game*”, etc., while including the brand “Raichu” in some keywords (e.g. “Raichu game rules”) for branding. Long-tail variations (e.g. adding “online,” “free,” “how to”) capture search intent. The focus is on “*chess-adjacent*” queries, not chasing “play chess” (too competitive with sites like Chess.com ³).

Competitor Analysis

We audit key sites to extract SEO patterns:

Site	Example Title Tag	Target Keywords (from content)	Page Structure / Content	Internal Links	Notable Schema/ Notes
Chess.com	Likely “Play Chess Online – Chess.com”	chess, play chess online, chess variants	Heavy focus on “Play” and “Learn”. Variants landing pages.	Global nav to play, learn, community; content pages link to variants (if allowed).	No visible schema; global top authority (difficult to compete on core “chess”).
Lichess.org	<i>lichess.org</i> • <i>Free Online Chess</i> ⁴	free online chess, open source	Home with event news; sections for puzzles, learn, tools.	Nav: Play (lobby), Learn, Watch, Community links.	Emphasizes free, open-source. No obvious SEO content.
PlayStrategy	<i>playstrategy.org</i> • <i>2 player strategy games</i>	abstract games, mind sports, play dozens games	Home: intro, “Play dozens of games in browser” ⁵ .	Nav to games, tournaments, learn, community.	Focus on “two-player abstract strategy games” ⁶ . No schema noted.

Site	Example Title Tag	Target Keywords (from content)	Page Structure / Content	Internal Links	Notable Schema/ Notes
PlayAbstractGames	(likely) <i>Play Abstract Games – Free Board Games</i>	abstract strategy, no luck, AI levels	Home: tagline “No dice. No luck.” ⁷ . Sections on classics and “What Are Abstract Strategy Games?” ⁸ .	Nav to game play pages, About/FAQ.	Emphasizes “abstract strategy” keywords ⁸ .
AbstractBoardGames	<i>Play Abstract Strategy Board Games Online – Free Games</i> ⁹	abstract, strategy, two-player	List of games with tags (e.g. “abstract”, “chess-like”, etc.) ¹⁰ . Minimal copy.	Each game links to play or info; static lists.	Good use of keyword tags; lacks content for Google.
ChessFort (Variants)	<i>Best Chess Variants – ChessFort</i> ¹¹	chess variants, popular variants	List of top variants with descriptions (Chess960, Atomic, etc.) ¹² ¹³ .	Links to Wikipedia for each game.	Title “Best Chess Variants” targets “chess variant” search.
247chess.com	<i>Chess 247 - Play Free Chess Games Online</i> ¹⁴	chess rules, how to play chess	“How to play chess” guide: objectives, setup, rules ¹⁵ .	Menu: Chess, +Games, News; internal links to rules, tutorials.	Heavy content on chess basics; keywords: “play free chess games online”.

Insights:

- **Title Patterns:** All use “[Site] – [Action/Descriptor]”. E.g. “Play Free Chess...”, “Best Chess Variants”, “Abstract Strategy Board Games Online” ⁹. Titles include target phrases like “Free Chess”, “Abstract Strategy Board Games”, “Chess Variants”.

- **Keyword Use:** Good pages mention chess and related terms upfront (Chess, variants, strategy, free, play). Abstract game sites repeatedly use “abstract strategy”, “no luck”, “play in browser” (PlayAbstractGames ⁸). We should similarly pepper relevant terms and define them.
- **Content Structure:** Winning sites often have clear sections with headings (Chess 247 uses H2/H3 for setup and rules ¹⁵; PlayAbstractGames defines “What Are Abstract Strategy Games?” ¹⁶). Use H2 for rules/sections.
- **Internal Linking:** Most link to play pages and related info. E.g. Chess 247’s basic tutorial links to “play chess online” ¹⁷. We should mirror: homepage links to rules/how-to/play, and each page links to related pages as detailed in instructions.
- **Content Gaps:**
 - Few sites explicitly target “chess-inspired abstract games.” ChessFort lists variants but focuses on classic names, not new indie games.
 - No competitor mentions “Raichu” or similar (as it’s unique). Raichu can fill a niche among “Chess variants” and “abstract games.”
 - PlayAbstractGames and PlayStrategy focus on classics; Raichu adds novelty.
 - Many rely on text with structured lists (e.g. AbstractBoardGames uses tags). Raichu’s site should use both descriptive copy and metadata tags.
 - **Schema:** These competitors seem to use minimal schema. We plan to implement structured data (Game, HowTo, FAQPage, BreadcrumbList) for an edge.
 - **Copy Tone:** Competitors use concise headings and lists (Chess 247 uses bullet lists for pieces ¹⁸; PlayAbstractGames uses short feature points ⁷). We’ll do the same, keeping language simple and active.

Site Architecture

Page Map: We propose the following core pages (URL | Title | Purpose):

URL	Title (Example)	Purpose/Content
/ (Home)	*Raichu Game	Play a Chess-Inspired Strategy Board Game Online*
/play	*Play Raichu Online	Free Chess-Style Strategy Game*
/rules	*Raichu Game Rules	How to Play Raichu*
/how-to-play	*How to Play Raichu	Beginner Guide & Strategy Basics*
/strategy	*Raichu Strategy Guide	Tactics, Openings, and Tips*
/chess-like-games	<i>Best Chess-Like Games to Play Online</i>	Discovery list: Chess, Shogi, Go, etc. Define “chess-like”. Brief compare, mention Raichu. (Internal: link to Raichu, rules, play)
/abstract-strategy-games	<i>Abstract Strategy Games: Chess, Go, Hex, Shogi, and Raichu</i>	Category page: explain abstract games (no luck, full info) and list examples, link to Raichu, Chess-like, other blogs.
/chess-variants	<i>Chess Variants and Chess-Inspired Games Explained</i>	Clarify “variant vs inspired”. Explain popular variants (Crazyhouse, etc.), then Raichu as chess-inspired but not a variant.

URL	Title (Example)	Purpose/Content
/raichu-vs-chess	*Raichu vs Chess	Similarities, Differences, Strategy*
/faq	<i>Raichu Game FAQ</i>	Q&A (see list below). Answers with links to relevant pages.
/blog	<i>Raichu Game Blog & News</i>	Hub for articles (the roadmap articles below).

```
graph LR
    Home(("Home<br>Raichu Game"))
    Play(("Play<br>Raichu Online"))
    Rules(("Rules<br>Raichu Game Rules"))
    HowTo(("How-to Play<br>Raichu Guide"))
    Strategy(("Strategy<br>Raichu Tips"))
    ChessLike(("Chess-Like Games<br>e.g. Chess, Shogi"))
    AbstractGames(("Abstract Strategy Games"))
    Variants(("Chess Variants Explained"))
    VsChess(("Raichu vs Chess"))
    FAQ(("FAQ"))
    Blog(("Blog"))

    Home --> Play
    Home --> Rules
    Home --> HowTo
    Home --> Strategy
    Home --> FAQ
    Home --> ChessLike
    ChessLike --> AbstractGames
    ChessLike --> Variants
    AbstractGames --> Play
    AbstractGames --> ChessLike
    Variants --> VsChess
    ChessLike --> VsChess
    HowTo --> Play
    HowTo --> Rules
    Strategy --> Play
    Strategy --> Rules
    FAQ --> Play
    FAQ --> Rules
    FAQ --> HowTo
    Blog --> Play
    Blog --> ChessLike
```

Notes: Every page has a unique URL, title, and meta description. The homepage links to all core pages. Category pages (Chess-Like, Abstract Games, Variants) link to relevant content and to Raichu pages. **Footer** links should include Play, Rules, How-to, Strategy, FAQ, Blog.

Metadata Plan

Proposed titles, metas, H1s (for example) for core pages:

Page	Title (max ~60 chars)	Meta Description (max ~155 chars)	H1 Heading	Schema Type(s)
Home (/)	Raichu Game	Play a Chess-Inspired Strategy Board Game Online	Play Raichu, a fast chess-inspired abstract strategy game in your browser. Learn rules and tactics, then challenge your mind.	Raichu Game: A Chess-Inspired Strategy Game
Play (/play)	Play Raichu Online	Free Chess-Style Strategy Game	Play Raichu in your browser and hone your tactics in this free chess-inspired strategy game.	(same as title or brief intro)
Rules (/rules)	Raichu Game Rules	How to Play Raichu	Raichu Game Rules: How to Play Raichu	WebPage or Article
How-to-Play (/how-to-play)	How to Play Raichu	Beginner Guide & Strategy	How to Play Raichu: Beginner Guide	HowTo
Strategy (/strategy)	Raichu Strategy Guide	Tactics, Openings, and Tips	Raichu Strategy Guide	Article
Chess-like-games	Best Chess-Like Games to Play Online	Discover the best chess-inspired and abstract board games. Explore Chess, Shogi, Go, and the new Raichu game.	Best Chess-Like Games to Play Online	Article
Abstract-strategy-games	Abstract Strategy Games: Chess, Go, Hex, Shogi, and Raichu	Learn about abstract strategy games (no luck, pure skill) and play classics like Chess, Go, Hex – plus Raichu online.	Abstract Strategy Games Explained	Article

Page	Title (max ~60 chars)	Meta Description (max ~155 chars)	H1 Heading	Schema Type(s)
Chess-variants (/ chess-variants)	Chess Variants and Chess-Inspired Games Explained	What makes a chess variant vs. a new game? Learn how Raichu relates to Chess variants and other strategy games.	Chess Variants and Inspired Games	Article
Raichu-vs-chess	Raichu vs Chess	Similarities, Differences, Strategy Tips	Raichu vs Chess: Similarities & Differences	Article
FAQ (/faq)	Raichu Game FAQ	Frequently asked questions about the Raichu strategy game – rules, strategy, and how to play.	Raichu Game FAQ	FAQPage
Blog (/blog)	Raichu Game Blog & News	Articles and guides on Raichu and other strategy board games. Tips, news, and strategy.	Raichu Game Blog	Blog (collection of Article pages)

Example snippet usage:

- Home meta: “Play Raichu, a fast chess-inspired abstract strategy game in your browser. Learn rules and tactics, then challenge your mind.” (concise, inviting) ¹⁹ ¹ .
- Chess-like-games meta: “Discover chess-inspired and abstract board games: Chess, Shogi, Go, and Raichu” (hits key phrases).
- All meta descriptions should be unique and capture user intent (per Google guidelines ¹ ²⁰).

Schema Plan

Implement JSON-LD structured data for enhanced results:

- **Homepage & Play page:** `VideoGame` or `Game` schema. Include:
 - `name: "Raichu Game"` ;
 - `applicationCategory: "Game"` or `Abstract strategy game` ;
 - `gamePlatform: "Web browser"` ;
 - `genre: "Abstract strategy"` ;
 - `playMode: "SinglePlayer"` or `"Multiplayer"` depending on support;
 - `description: "A chess-inspired abstract strategy board game playable in your browser."`

This tells Google this is a video game and eligible for game-rich snippets.

- **Rules page:** Could use `HowTo` if steps (objectives, setup, moves, etc.) are listed as steps. Or leave as standard page with breadcrumb.
- **HowTo-Play page:** Use `HowTo` schema with steps (e.g., "Step 1: setup, Step 2: first move"). This can yield rich snippets.
- **Strategy page:** Use `Article` schema if it's educational content.
- **Category pages (Chess-like, Abstract games, Variants, vs-chess):** Use `Article` or `ItemList` schema listing the games or comparisons.
- **FAQ page:** Use `FAQPage` schema with each question/answer pair (the Qs below). This can show FAQ rich results.
- **Blog posts:** Use `Article` (or `TechArticle`) schema, with author and date.
- **All pages:** Include `BreadcrumbList` schema for breadcrumbs (Home > Category > Page) ²¹. This helps Google show breadcrumb trails.
- **Site root:** `WebSite` schema (with `name: "Raichu Game", url: "https://raichugame.example.com"`) to identify the site.

Google recommends JSON-LD in head ² ²². We should *not* mix Microdata. Follow Google guidelines: one object per page as appropriate. Validate with Rich Results Test after deployment.

Internal Linking Plan

- **Header/Nav:** Include links to Play, Rules, How-to, Strategy, FAQ, Chess-like-games, Abstract-games, Chess-variants. This ensures crawlability and UX.
- **Footer:** Links to core pages and blog.
- **Homepage:** Links to Play, Rules, How-to, Strategy, FAQ prominently (e.g. in sections or buttons). Also link to category pages (e.g. "Chess-like Games" list).
- **Rules page:** Link to How-to (for practical play), Strategy.
- **How-to page:** Link to Play (call to action) and Rules (for formal rules).
- **Strategy page:** Link to Play and Rules (to test strategy).
- **Chess-like Games page:** Link to Raichu vs Chess (for comparing), to Play (highlight Raichu), to Rules.
- **Abstract Games page:** Link to Chess-like games and Play (promote Raichu among others).
- **Chess Variants page:** Link to Raichu vs Chess and Chess-like games (making Raichu context).
- **Raichu vs Chess:** Link back to Play, Rules, Strategy for Raichu.
- **FAQ page:** Answer links to each relevant page (e.g. answer "How do you win Raichu?" linking to Rules).
- **Blog pages:** Each blog post should link to relevant core pages (and other blog posts) naturally within content.

This mesh ensures that any page can reach any other within a few clicks, helping both users and crawlers.

Content & Blog Roadmap

We'll produce focused content beyond core pages to target long-tail terms. Here are 20 article ideas with outlines:

1. **What Makes a Game Chess-Like?** – Define "chess-like" (similar pieces, perfect info, strategy depth). Compare Chess, Shogi, Xiangqi, Chess960. Place Raichu as another chess-inspired game. *Outline:* Define criteria (board, pieces, no randomness) → List examples → Raichu's "chessness".
2. **Top 10 Strategy Board Games Like Chess** – List games (Go, Shogi, Arimaa, Onitama, Hive, etc.); include Raichu and browser-playable games. *Outline:* Criteria for "like chess" → Game list with short descriptions → Why each appeals to chess players.
3. **Chess Variants vs Chess-Inspired Games** – Explain difference: variants use chess rules + tweaks vs. inspired games with different mechanics. Raichu is in latter. *Outline:* Define variant vs inspired → Examples (Crazyhouse vs Raichu) → Benefits of each → Where Raichu fits.
4. **Why Abstract Strategy Games Are Timeless** – Appeal: no luck, full information, deep tactics. Mention classics (Go, Chess) and why new games still matter. *Outline:* Traits (perfect info, deep skill) → History appeal → Modern scene (AI, online) → Include Raichu as new abstract game.
5. **How to Design a Strategy Board Game Like Chess** – High-level guide: simple rules, deep tactics, balanced pieces. Could mention designers' perspective. *Outline:* Principles (abstract, no luck) → Steps (board design, piece moves, goal) → Test & iterate → Relate to how Raichu was designed.
6. **Raichu Opening Principles for Beginners** – Advice: central control, tempo. *Outline:* Key opening goals → Sample first moves (with diagrams ideally) → Common pitfalls → Link to how-to-play and rules.
7. **Common Beginner Mistakes in Raichu (And How to Fix Them)** – Point out errors: ignoring defense, overextending. *Outline:* 4-5 mistakes (e.g. neglecting tempo) → Example scenario → Correction tips.
8. **Advanced Raichu Tactics: Control, Tempo, and Pressure** – Dive into midgame strategy. *Outline:* Explain "board control" concept → Using threats (pressure) → Tempo swings → Sample tactic.
9. **Endgame in Raichu: Tips to Secure a Win** – Guide endgame technique. *Outline:* Typical endgame scenarios → Key goals (e.g. promote or trap king) → Example endgame positions.
10. **Best Free Browser Strategy Games You Can Play Now** – List free online games (Lichess, PlayAbstractGames, Raichu, etc.). *Outline:* Introduction to browser games → List with short notes (name, site, style) → Raichu included.
11. **How Raichu Combines Elements of Chess and [Another Game]** – Compare Raichu to a lesser-known abstract (e.g. Arimaa or Onitama). *Outline:* Brief intro of comparison game → Similarities to Raichu → Unique differences → Why combination works.
12. **The Abstract Game Renaissance: New Titles for Tactical Thinkers** – Trend piece on new abstract games (Raichu, etc.). *Outline:* Past vs present (Euro, abstract revival) → Mention Raichu and a few others (maybe Hive expansions).
13. **Online Chess Variants: Where to Play and Learn** – Directory of sites (Chess.com, Lichess, ChessFort, etc.) *Outline:* Intro chess variants → List sites for variants → Brief on each (Chess.com has Bughouse/4P, Lichess has crazyhouse) → Mention Raichu's site as unique indie option.
14. **Raichu vs. Chess: A Deep Dive** – Summarize major points: piece moves, goals, strategy differences. *Outline:* Side-by-side table (or headings) → Similarities (abstract, two-player) and differences (Board size? piece types? win conditions) → Who might prefer Raichu.

15. **Tactical Board Games for Kids: Easy to Learn, Hard to Master** – Focus on family audiences. Include Raichu if suitable. *Outline:* Concept of easy rules but deep play → Examples (Checkers, Connect4) → Raichu pitched as “simple rule set, strategic depth”.
16. **The Role of Luck in Board Games** – Explain “no-luck” games appeal. Chess/Go/Raichu as examples. *Outline:* Luck vs skill → Famous luck games (Monopoly) vs pure skill (chess) → Psychology and skill learning → Raichu’s pure-skill nature.
17. **Comparing Strategy vs Tactics: Chess, Raichu, and Abstract Games** – Educational piece on concepts. *Outline:* Define strategy vs tactics → Examples from chess (positional advantage) and Raichu (tempo) → How games teach these.
18. **Raichu for Chess Players: Why You Should Try This Game** – Persuasive piece for chess audience. *Outline:* What chess players love (depth, perfect info) → How Raichu fits those → New challenges it offers.
19. **History of Chess Variants** – Timeline of variants and modern abstracts. *Outline:* Ancient to modern (Fischer Random in 90s, crazyhouse online era) → Rise of indie designs (Raichu mention) → Chess culture’s openness to variants.
20. **Strategy Spotlight: From Chess to Raichu** – Guest post style, discussing learning process. *Outline:* Story of learning a new game (say by hypothetical author) → Comparing learning chess vs Raichu → Encouragement.

Each article will be an **article schema**. Outline bullets help writing. These posts target discovery and how-to phrases. Interlink them with core pages (e.g. “see game rules” linking to /rules). Cite authoritative sources when possible (e.g., BoardGameGeek for lists, or SEO blogs for tips). For example, ChessFort ²³ can be cited for variant names if needed.

Technical SEO Checklist

- **Unique Titles and Meta Descriptions:** Each page must have a unique `<title>` and `<meta description>` ¹. Titles include target keywords and site name. Meta descriptions are concise summaries (one per page, not keyword-stuffed) ²⁰.
- **Single H1 per page:** Each page must have one clear `<h1>` reflecting the page’s main topic (as in metadata plan).
- **Clean URLs:** Use simple, hyphenated URLs (e.g. `/how-to-play`) that match page names. Avoid query strings for core pages.
- **Canonical Tags:** Set `<link rel="canonical">` on each page to its own URL to avoid duplicate content issues.
- **Sitemap & Robots:** Create `sitemap.xml` listing all public SEO pages; add `robots.txt` allowing crawling of these pages. Exclude any dev or admin pages. Submit sitemap in Search Console.
- **Structured Data:** Add JSON-LD as above (Game, HowTo, FAQPage, BreadcrumbList, Article). Validate with Google’s Rich Results Test to ensure eligibility.
- **Open Graph / Twitter Cards:** Set OG `title`, `description`, and `image` tags for social sharing (use main game screenshot or logo). Also set Twitter card metadata.
- **BreadcrumbList:** Implement on all info pages to reflect site structure ²¹.
- **Mobile-friendly & Speed:** Ensure responsive design and fast loading (compress assets, use caching). Test via Google’s Mobile-Friendly and PageSpeed tools.
- **No Hidden/Spam Content:** Avoid keyword stuffing or hidden text. Keep content user-focused.
- **Internal Links & Alt Text:** Add descriptive anchor text when linking internally. Add `alt` text to all images (describe content in a non-keywordy way) ²⁴.

- **No Duplicate Content:** Each page's content should be unique. Don't copy from competitors. Check that no two pages share the same title/meta.
- **Accessibility:** Use semantic HTML, captions for images, and ARIA roles where needed.
- **Analytics and Webmaster Tools:** Install Google Analytics and Search Console for tracking and error monitoring.

By following Google's SEO best practices (e.g. unique clear titles, descriptive metas, structured data) ¹ ² , we set up Raichu for crawlability and improved click-through in search.

30-Day Launch Plan

A four-week timeline with weekly milestones:

```

gantt
title 30-Day SEO Launch Plan
dateFormat YYYY-MM-DD
section Week 1 (Planning & Basics)
Keyword Research & Plan      :a1, 2026-05-12, 2d
Competitor Audit             :a2, after a1, 3d
Site Structure & Architecture:a3, after a2, 2d
Setup CMS & Dev Environment  :a4, after a3, 3d
section Week 2 (Core Content)
Write Home, Play, Rules      :b1, 2026-05-17, 3d
Write HowTo & Strategy        :b2, after b1, 3d
Develop Chess-like, Abstract :b3, after b2, 3d
Implement Schema & Metadata  :b4, parallel 3d
section Week 3 (Support Pages)
Write Variants & VsChess      :c1, 2026-05-24, 3d
Create FAQ content           :c2, after c1, 2d
Internal Linking & SEO Audit :c3, after c2, 2d
Launch Sitemap & Robots.txt  :c4, after c3, 1d
section Week 4 (Content Expansion & Outreach)
Draft 1st Blog Posts         :d1, 2026-05-31, 5d
Implement Social Metadata    :d2, after d1, 1d
Quality Assurance & Testing  :d3, parallel 2d
Official Launch & Promotion  :d4, 2026-06-07, 1d
Monitor Analytics/KPIs       :d5, after d4, 2d

```

Milestones & KPIs:

- **Week 1:** Complete research and plan. (Confirm keyword targets, competitor insights.)
- **Week 2:** Publish core pages (Home, Play, Rules, How-to, Strategy) with SEO optimizations. *KPI:* Pages indexed; check titles/descriptions appear correctly in Google Search Console.
- **Week 3:** Launch remaining pages (categories, FAQ). *KPI:* All core pages in sitemap and index; crawl errors fixed; at least 1 link from homepage to each core page (internal linking complete).

- **Week 4:** Publish first 3–5 blog articles. Begin promotion. *KPI:* Google Analytics showing initial sessions. Aim for **ranking** in top 20 for at least a few long-tail terms (like “how to play Raichu”) within a month. Also track organic traffic (target: 100+ visits by day 30), and monitor bounce/time on site for content quality.

(Google notes SEO impact can take weeks to months ²⁵. Early signs like indexing and some keyword movements can be expected by ~4 weeks.)

Implementation Tasks

#	Task	Description	Priority
1	Build Pages & Structure	Create page templates (Home, Play, Rules, etc.) with H1 and sections. Configure URL routes and CMS or static generator.	High
2	Write Homepage Copy	Draft Home content (intro, benefits, difference from chess). Include links to play and other pages.	High
3	Develop Game Interface (Play page)	Embed Raichu game code/iframe. Add brief intro text, link to rules.	High
4	Write Rules Page	Author clear rules: objective, setup, movement, capture, win, examples. Use subheadings.	High
5	Write How-to-Play Guide	Step-by-step instructions, first moves, tips. Ensure “HowTo” steps format.	High
6	Write Strategy Guide	Advanced tactics content (openings, tempo, etc.). Use bullet points for tips.	Medium
7	Write Chess-like and Abstract pages	Content on chess-like games list and abstract games category. Mention Raichu contextually.	Medium
8	Write Chess-Variants & Raichu-vs-Chess	Explain variants vs new game; compare Raichu and Chess features.	Medium
9	Write FAQ Content	Prepare Q&A list from spec (e.g. “Is Raichu free to play?”) and succinct answers.	High
10	Create Blog Articles	Draft planned blog posts with headings. Optimize for keywords.	Medium
11	Add Metadata (Title/ Meta/H1)	Insert titles, metas, H1s as per metadata plan on each page.	High
12	Implement Schema Markup	Add JSON-LD scripts for Game (homepage), HowTo, FAQ, Breadcrumbs. Validate with Google’s tool.	High
13	Internal Linking	Ensure each page links as per plan. Double-check no orphan pages.	High

#	Task	Description	Priority
14	Sitemap & Robots	Generate sitemap.xml with all page URLs. Write robots.txt allowing site crawl.	High
15	Setup Analytics & Webmaster Tools	Install Google Analytics, set up Google Search Console and Bing Webmaster with site and sitemap.	High
16	Add Social Meta Tags	Add Open Graph and Twitter card tags (title, description, image) to pages.	Medium
17	Mobile Optimization	Test site on mobile; fix any issues. Ensure responsive layout.	Medium
18	Page Speed Optimization	Compress images, minify code, leverage caching. Aim for fast load.	Medium
19	Final QA and Testing	Proofread copy, check all links, test forms/games. Use Rich Results Test for schema.	High
20	Launch and Monitor	Go live. Monitor Google Search Console for indexing. Track ranking progress and traffic.	High

Each task should be assigned in priority order. After launch, continue iterating on content, monitor analytics, and adjust SEO (e.g. refine keywords if needed).

Sources: SEO best practices from Google's documentation ¹ ² ²¹ and analysis of top abstract strategy game sites (PlayStrategy ⁶ , PlayAbstractGames ¹⁹ , ChessFort ²³ , 247Chess ²⁶) guided the above recommendations.

¹ ²⁰ ²⁴ ²⁵ SEO Starter Guide: The Basics | Google Search Central | Documentation | Google for Developers

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/seo-starter-guide>

² ²² Intro to How Structured Data Markup Works | Google Search Central | Documentation | Google for Developers

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/structured-data/intro-structured-data>

³ Play Chess Variants Online - Chess.com

<https://www.chess.com/variants>

⁴ lichess.org • Free Online Chess

<https://lichess.org/>

⁵ ⁶ About playstrategy.org • playstrategy.org

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⁷ ⁸ ¹⁶ ¹⁹ Play Abstract Games Online for Free - Play Abstract Games

<https://playabstractgames.com/en/>

⁹ ¹⁰ Play Abstract Strategy Board Games Online - Free Games

<https://abstractboardgames.com/>

11 12 13 23 List of the most popular chess variants played online

<https://chessfort.com/collection/variants/>

14 15 17 18 26 Chess 247 - Play Free Chess Games Online

<https://www.247chess.com/>

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<https://www.blissdrive.com/people-also-asked/what-is-breadcrumblist-schema/>